

Get the Facts on Atrial Fibrillation



HEART INSTITUTE

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What is Atrial Fibrillation (AFib)?

AFib is caused by the heart's electrical signals being out of sync. This means the heart's upper chamber (the atria) cannot properly pump blood into the heart's lower chamber (the ventricles).

The result is a fast, uncontrolled heartbeat that if left untreated, can lead to blood clots, a stroke or heart failure.



What are the symptoms?



While some patients might feel constant heart palpitations (heavy pounding), other patients might feel no symptoms at all. Screening for AFib based on its risk factors is critical. Other symptoms of AFib besides palpitations are included to the right.



Who gets this condition?

Anyone can get AFib. However, the most common risk factors for the condition include:

- Advanced age (over 60)
- Diabetes
- Coronary artery disease, heart failure and heart valve disease
- Obesity
- High blood pressure
- Sleep apnea
- Excessive alcohol or stimulant use
- Thyroid disease
- Serious illness or infection



How can I find out if I have AFib? How can I get it treated?

Talk to your doctor, who will review your medical and family histories, do a physical exam, and perform a test such as an EKG to determine if you have AFib.

Orlando Health Heart Institute treats AFib using various ablation therapies. Recovery time from these therapies is generally fast, and the success rate is high.

DID YOU KNOW?



**AFib is the most common
HEART ARRHYTHMIA or
IRREGULAR HEARTBEAT**

Symptoms Include:

- A skipped or racing heartbeat
- Chest pain
- Shortness of breath
- Dizziness
- Lightheadedness or fainting

**AFib affects an estimated
3 MILLION AMERICANS**

**AFib is a leading
cause of STROKE**

**80% of strokes can
be prevented**

Questions For Your Physician:

1. What's causing my symptoms?
2. What are my treatment options?
3. What tests do I need?
4. Should I make lifestyle changes?
5. How important is managing AFib?

If you have been diagnosed with or believe you may be at risk for Atrial Fibrillation, contact us today. Our knowledgeable and experienced cardiology experts are here to help. Make an appointment with an Orlando Health Heart Institute physician by calling 321.843.2001.